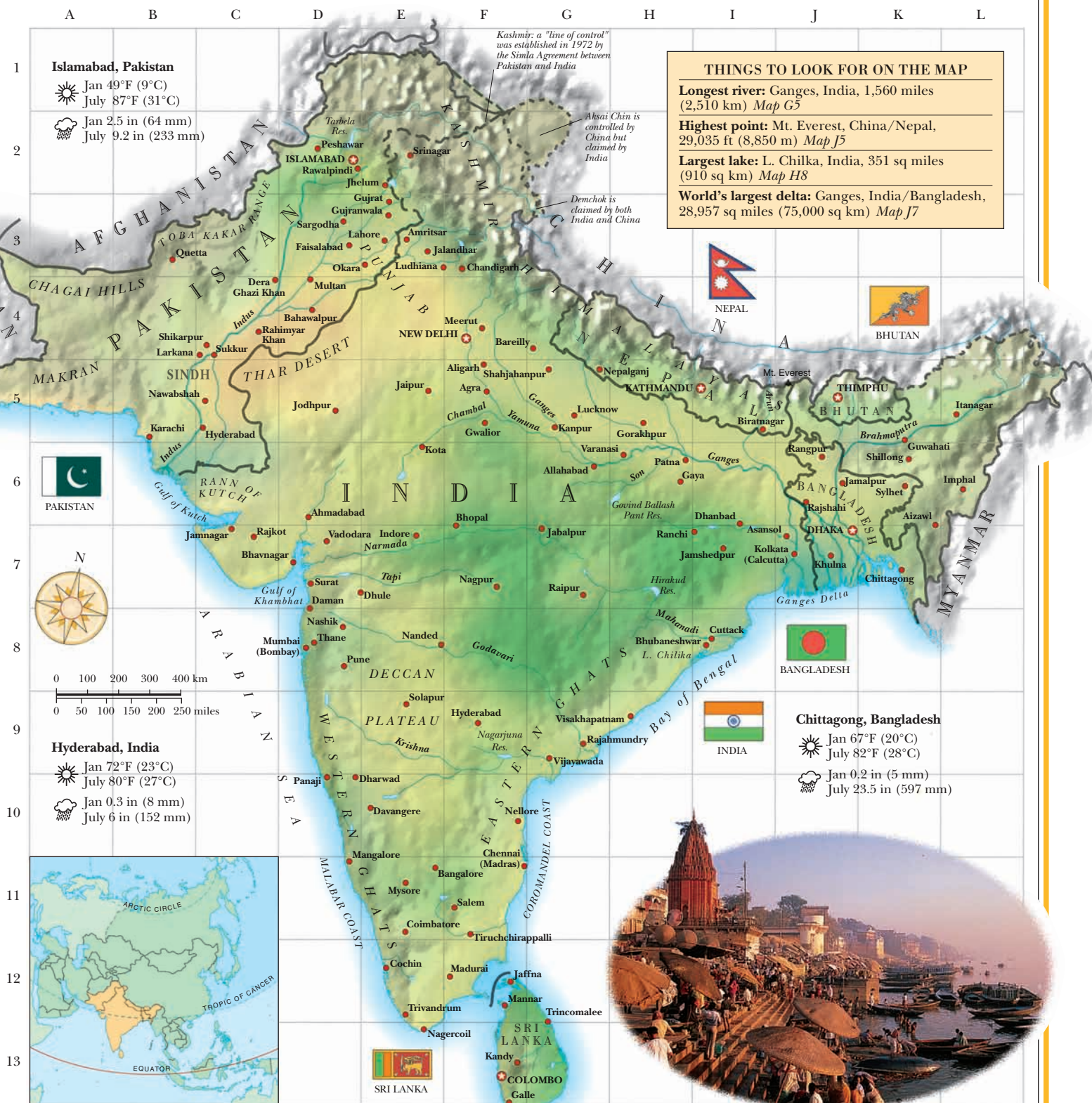




ENDANGERED WILDLIFE
 The Subcontinent is rich in wildlife, from elephants and rhinoceroses to monkeys and mongooses. Loss of habitat and poaching are serious threats to India's most famous animals, including tigers. Despite the establishment of protected reserves, illegal tiger-hunting continues. Only around 3,000 tigers are left in the wild.



SACRED RIVER

Followers of five of the world's major religions live in the Indian Subcontinent – Hindus, Muslims, Buddhists, Sikhs, and Christians. The majority of people are Hindu and their holiest city is Varanasi, in northern India. The city stands on the banks of the Ganges, the sacred river of the Hindus. Millions of pilgrims come to Varanasi each year to bathe in the river. This is believed to wash away their sins.